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ABOUT

Undergraduate researcher at Fudan University majoring in Artificial Intelligence (ranked 1st in class, GPA 3.93/4.0). Currently conducting research on large reasoning models, agents, and interpretability at FudanNLP ALEX Lab, advised by Prof. Yixin Cao. Published 5 papers, including 1 ACL 2026 Findings paper and 4 arXiv preprints. Will be an exchange student at UC San Diego in Fall 2026. Passionate about advancing the frontiers of AI reasoning and committed to a career in AI research.

EDUCATION

2024.9 – Present	Fudan University — B.Eng. in Artificial Intelligence School of Computer Science (Honors Track). GPA 3.93/4.0, ranked 1st in major.
2026.9 – 2027.1	UC San Diego — Exchange Student Computer Science & Engineering.
2021.9 – 2024.6	The High School Affiliated to Fudan University — Buqing Honors Class

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025.10 – Present	FudanNLP ALEX Lab — Undergraduate Researcher Advised by Prof. Yixin Cao. Research on Large Reasoning Model capabilities, agent systems, and mechanistic interpretability. Produced 5 papers (including 1 ACL 2026 Findings).
2025.3 – 2025.6	Embodied Intelligence Research Project — Tengfei Innovation Program Advised by Prof. Shang Li. Built small-scale robots with asynchronous servo motor control and embedded development board integration.

PUBLICATIONS

- Junjie Nian^{*}, Kang Chen^{*}, Ge Zhang, Yixin Cao, Yugang Jiang. “TraceGraph: Shared Decision Landscapes for Diagnosing and Improving Agent Trajectories.” [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Kang Chen^{*}, Junjie Nian^{*}, Yixin Cao, Yugang Jiang. “SliceGraph: Mapping Process Isomers in Multi-Run Chain-of-Thought Reasoning.” [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Kang Chen^{*}, Zhuoka Feng^{*}, Sihan Zhao, Kai Xiong, Junjie Nian, Yaoning Wang, Changyi Xiao, Yixin Cao. “NEX: Neuron Explore-Exploit Scoring for Label-Free Chain-of-Thought Selection and Model Ranking.” [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Kang Chen^{*}, Fan Yu^{*}, Junjie Nian, Shihan Zhao, Zhuoka Feng, Zijun Yao, Heng Wang, Minshen Yu, Yixin Cao. “Thinking Traps in Long Chain-of-Thought: A Measurable Study and Trap-Aware Adaptive Restart.” [Findings of ACL, ACL 2026.](#) [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Zhuoka Feng^{*}, Kang Chen^{*}, Sihan Zhao[†], Kai Xiong[†], Yaoning Wang[†], Minshen Yu, Junjie Nian, Changyi Xiao, Yixin Cao, Yugang Jiang. “ARM: Role-Conditioned Neuron Transplantation for Training-Free Generalist LLM Agent Merging.” [\[arXiv\]](#)

* Equal contribution † Equal second-author contribution

HONORS & AWARDS

Duckbill Special Scholarship, Fudan University (equivalent to First-Class Outstanding Student Scholarship)	2025
Third Prize, China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modelling, Shanghai	2025
Third Prize, The Chinese Mathematics Competitions for College Students, Shanghai	2025
Freshman Scholarship, Fudan University (New Engineering Discipline)	2025
First Prize, Tengfei College Entrance Exam Freshman Scholarship, Fudan University	2024

SELECTED PROJECTS

TraceGraph: Shared Decision Landscapes for Diagnosing and Improving Agent Trajectories

Graph-based framework that converts multi-model agent rollouts into a shared decision landscape with productive cores, trap regions, and repair events. Uses this process view to diagnose benchmark behavior and support trap-aware recovery strategies for improving agent trajectories.

[\[arXiv\]](#) [\[Code Coming Soon\]](#)

SliceGraph: Mapping Process Isomers in Multi-Run Chain-of-Thought Reasoning

Post-hoc graph view of multi-run Chain-of-Thought reasoning built from similarity between reasoning slices. Shows that runs reaching the same final answer often travel through distinct process families and shared intermediate reasoning states, revealing process geometry missed by final-answer aggregation.

[\[arXiv\]](#) [\[GitHub\]](#)

CoT Folding: Structural Analysis of LLM Reasoning Trajectories

Framework treating Chain-of-Thought as analogous to protein folding. Measures pairwise similarity between token segments using neuron activation patterns to reveal compact cores, long-range return connections, and drifting branches. Proposes Native Fold Score (NFS), a fully unsupervised, parameter-free quality metric for CoT reasoning.

[\[GitHub\]](#)

Multilingual Neuron Analysis for LLM Reasoning

Extended the **NAD** framework to multilingual settings across 18 languages and 2,250 math reasoning samples. Found that quality reasoning neurons are 99.8% language-agnostic; moderate code-switching outperforms monolingual reasoning by +68.8%.

[\[GitHub\]](#)

80/20 Rule of Token Entropy in LLM Reasoning

Independent reproduction and extension of **Qwen team's NeurIPS 2025 work** with five-metric comparison, multilingual CoT analysis, and entropy-frequency correlation study across 539K+ samples and 70M+ tokens.

[\[GitHub\]](#)

Paper Assistant System

Full-stack academic platform: AI-powered LaTeX editor (GLM-4 feedback, real-time compilation, Monaco with SyncTeX) and ArXiv Paper Agent with automated daily scoring. React + FastAPI.

[\[GitHub\]](#)

SKILLS

Programming: Python, C/C++

AI / Research: PyTorch, NumPy/SciPy, neuron-level interpretability analysis, data analysis & visualization

Engineering: React, FastAPI, Three.js, Docker, LaTeX

Math & Physics: National Physics Olympiad Second Prize (x2); full marks in all core math & physics courses

ENGLISH PROFICIENCY

TOEFL **111** CET-6 **619** CET-4 **636**